- The “core” industries witnessed a declined from 6.5% growth during 2012-13, to 2.7% during in 2013-14. This is because of decline in natural gas and crude oil production, and reduced growth in fertilizers, coal and refinery products.

49. Statement I: CORRECT—Removal of Infrastructure Bottlenecks: For improving infrastructure there is a need to alter coal production by permitting commercial coal mining. Also, a restructuring of power distribution, upgradation of road and rail networks, reduction in delays for regulatory approvals, land acquisition and rehabilitation, require urgent attention. Projects need to be considered under public-private partnership (PPP) mode to attract private- sector investment in infrastructure.
Statement II: CORRECT—Facilitating Growth of Small Businesses: The informal sector lacks easy access to credit and technology while it a major contributor in GDP. Also, India’s ‘Ease of Doing Business’ ranking by the World Bank has been reduced from 131 to 134 out of the 189 countries in 2014. This needs to be CORRECTed by building a consensus among the States on best practices to be applicable to all the states and also to promote *self-certification, e-returns, and e-filings* to make business environment friendly for entrepreneurs and corporates as well.
    - There is a need to promote structural changes in Manufacturing industries in medium term for Indian economy. The medium-term challenge for Indian manufacturing is to progress from lower to higher technology consuming sectors; from lower to higher value-added-sectors; and from lower to higher productivity sectors.

50. Statement I: CORRECT—The government of India has decided to withdraw from the Industrial sector, and in accordance with this decision, it decided to privatise the public sector enterprises in a gradual and phased manner.
    - The approach adopted by the government in this regard is to bring down its equity shares in all non-strategic Public sector enterprises to 26% or lower.
    - For the purpose of privatisation, the government has adopted route of disinvestment which involves the sale of the public sector equity to the private sector.